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As talks go on, Harvard community feels left out

With a deal reportedly in sight, many call for school to be more transparent

By Anjali Huynh
and Aidan Ryan
GLOBE STAFF

Harvard University is nearing an agreement with the White House, in which the Cambridge institution could shell out hundreds of millions to get the government off its back. But as details of a possible deal have trickled out, those closely watching on campus say they’ve been left in the dark.

This has left some professors, students, and workers whose livelihoods are deeply dependent on Harvard increasingly restive — concerned that the secretive negotiations could leave them with little input on decisions that will shape the university’s future.

Harvard, they argue, needs to be much more transparent about what exactly is on the table in its discussions. The Trump administration

has been fixated on admissions and hiring, student discipline, and what level of oversight the government might have over Harvard going forward. Harvard could reportedly pay as much as \$500 million as part of an agreement.

“Faculty certainly don’t have any information about what the university administration has planned, besides what we read in the newspaper, and that is concerning in and of itself,” said Kirsten Weld, a Harvard history professor and president of the school’s chapter of the American Association of University Professors,

which is suing the Trump administration.

Weld added that faculty should have “ultimate purview over matters of academic freedom.”

The Trump administration has pulled nearly \$3 billion in federal research funding from Harvard and sought to revoke its ability to host international students. The moves have led to multiple lawsuits against the federal government, drawing vocal support from the president’s detractors who see the nation’s wealthiest university as best-positioned to

HARVARD, Page A7

Trump urged to hold line on Putin

European leaders stress need for him to seek cease-fire, seat for Ukraine in future talks

By Jim Tankersley
NEW YORK TIMES

BERLIN — European leaders said Wednesday that they have hammered out a strategy with President Trump for his scheduled meeting with President Vladimir Putin of Russia on Friday in Alaska to discuss ending the war in Ukraine, including an insistence that any peace plan must start with a cease-fire and not be negotiated without Ukraine at the table.

The trans-Atlantic discussions Wednesday were a last-minute effort by European leaders to close ranks with Trump before the Friday meeting. They came in a video call arranged by Chancellor Friedrich Merz of Germany. It included Trump, Vice President JD Vance, President Volodymyr Zelensky of Ukraine, and several other European leaders with strong relationships with Trump, including Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni of Italy.

Zelensky traveled to Berlin for the meeting and briefed reporters afterward with Merz.

“We had a truly exceptionally constructive and good conversation” with the president, Merz told reporters in brief remarks. “There is hope for movement; there is hope for peace in Ukraine,” he added.

Trump is famously mercurial, including on the issue of Ukraine. At several points in recent weeks, **UKRAINE, Page A5**

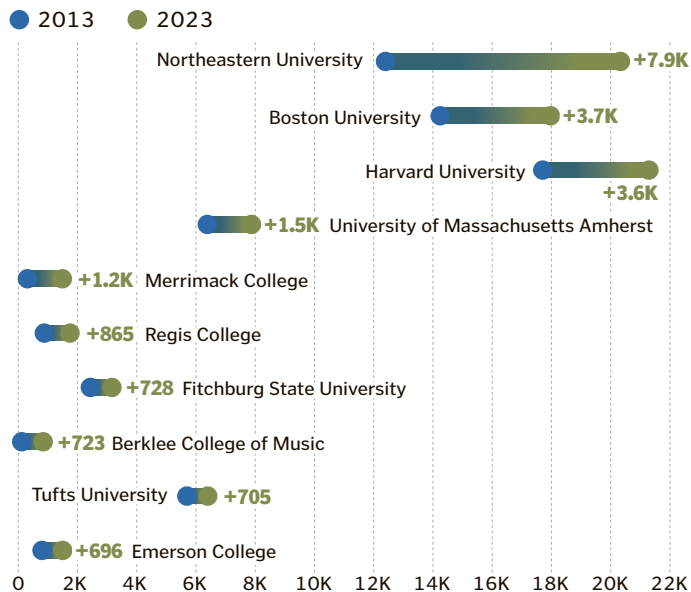
SPOILING THE PICTURE



PAT GREENHOUSE/GLOBE STAFF

It’s been a prime summer week, but high bacteria levels have caused a number of Massachusetts beaches, including Constitution Beach (above) in East Boston, to fail tests over the last year. Nearly 60 percent of beaches had unsafe levels of bacteria, indicating fecal contamination, on at least one testing day last year. **More on the rates, B1.**

Top 10 Mass. universities for graduate enrollment growth in 2023 vs. 2013



Profitable graduate programs may be forced to downsize

Federal loan caps, foreign student cuts will bring a shift

By Diti Kohli and Neena Hagen
GLOBE STAFF

Three decades ago, graduate school was a less profitable business in Massachusetts. Tuition was cheaper. Programs were smaller. And the sprawling landscape of online master’s courses, enabling universities to educate students all over the country, was unimaginable.

Then scores of Massachusetts colleges saw an explosion of graduate education. Schools created new advanced degrees in health care and technology and dramatically expanded master’s and

PhD enrollment. For every two graduate students here in 1998, there are three today, or about 150,000 in all.

Now the levers that powered this transformation are at risk. President Trump’s tax and spending law caps federal loans for graduate school for the first time in 20 years, including for costly programs such as medicine and law. Federally funded research that drew graduate students to Massachusetts colleges is being slashed. The White House is looking to curtail the number of foreign students — roughly 40,000 of whom are pursuing a graduate degree in Massachusetts.

Universities that rely on advanced degrees as a lucrative — and in some cases, essential — source of revenue are **GRADUATE ENROLLMENT, Page A10**

With US vaccine guidance in flux, Mass. trying to look ahead

By Jason Laughlin
GLOBE STAFF

Disruptions to national vaccine recommendations under Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. are starting to reverberate across Massachusetts, threatening the state’s access to COVID shots just as the annual season for respiratory viruses — and vaccines to protect against them — approaches.

Federal approval for flu and RSV vaccinations was granted only in the last few days, weeks later than is typical, and health officials are still waiting to learn whether the Trump administration will recommend any vaccinations for COVID. Insurers rely on that guidance to decide what doses they will cover.

Now, not knowing whether they’ll be reimbursed, local health providers have held off ordering vaccines for the fall period when people traditionally consider getting their annual shots.

“We’re really seriously considering not doing COVID vaccines this year,” said Laura Kittross, public health program manager for the Berkshire Regional Planning Commission, which coordinates with 18 Western Massachusetts municipalities. **VACCINES, Page A7**

Lobbyist Perullo allegedly was victim of Tompkins

‘Individual A’ identified as pot executive

By Andrew Ryan
GLOBE STAFF

The marijuana executive identified as “Individual A” in the federal indictment of Suffolk County Sheriff Steven Tompkins is longtime Boston lobbyist and political consultant Frank Perullo, business records and financial disclosures show.

Prosecutors portray Individual A as a victim of extortion by Tompkins, who they say used his position to elbow his way into a share of Perullo’s

nascent pot firm, and then demanded his money back when his \$50,000 investment tanked.

Perullo has operated behind the scenes in Democratic politics for decades, first as a 20-year-old in the secretary of

►Tompkins quits board of trustees at Roxbury Community College. **B1.**

state’s office and parlaying that experience into a political consulting firm that pioneered the use of voter data to redefine campaigns. After Massachusetts voters legalized marijuana in 2016, Perullo leveraged his connections around state **PERULLO, Page A10**



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

MAKING HER MARK — Omariah Ashley prepared to graduate Wednesday from the Boston fire academy, one of seven women among 71 graduates in the traditionally male-dominated field. **B1.**



Bolt ride

The White House promised a ramp-up of National Guard troops on the streets of Washington around the clock. **A2.**

Fewer Americans are reporting that they drink alcohol amid a growing belief that even moderate consumption is a health risk. **A2.**

Massachusetts is taking steps to protect the rights of immigrant and disabled students following recent ICE raids. **B1.**

Thursday: T-storms. High 80-85. Low 67-72.
Friday: Nice, less humid. High 74-79. Low 62-67.
High tide: 3:21 a.m., 3:45 p.m.
Sunrise: 5:50 Sunset: 7:47
Weather and Comics, D5-6. Obituaries, C9.

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